

EQUIPMENT

OF THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED for oil painting, the most important tools are your brushes, and the look of a painting depends on their quality. There are two main types of brushes: stiff hair bristle brushes made from hog hair, and soft hair brushes made from sable or synthetic material. You also need a certain

amount of solvent, such as turpentine or white spirit, to

dilute your oil colors and to clean off excess paint. Linseed oil, the basic binding medium for oil paint, can also be used to modify the consistency of colors. You can paint on many different surfaces and textures, but those used most frequently by oil painters are canvases and wooden panels. Keep equipment clean and always screw the lids back on bottles of solvent as they are a serious health hazard.

Bristle brushes

Brushes

Bristle brushes are mainly used for oil painting as they move the paint around on the textured surface of a canvas with ease. Soft hair brushes are good for small details and smooth effects. Oil painting brushes traditionally have long handles. Store your brushes safely when you aren't working with them.

Synthetic brush

Sable brush

Toe (tip) of brush

Heel of brush

Ferrule

Palette knife

Protective plastic case

Linen canvas

Primed canvas board

Wooden panel

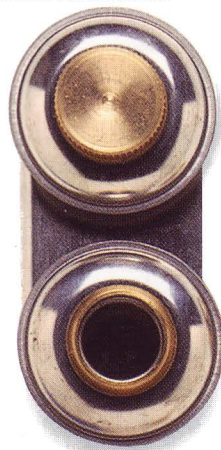
Painting surfaces

You can paint on almost any surface, including stone, glass, and metal. The materials most commonly used are canvases and wooden panels such as plywood, hardboard, and fibreboard. Commercially produced oil paper is good for trying out ideas and techniques.

Palette and painting knives

Palette knives are indispensable for moving paint around on a palette and cleaning it off. Painting knives, on the other hand, are used for applying paint and have a differently shaped blade and handle.

Painting knives



Dippers

These containers store small amounts of solvent and painting medium on a palette.